

INTERNATIONAL news

Federal court blocks Trump tariffs, easing fears

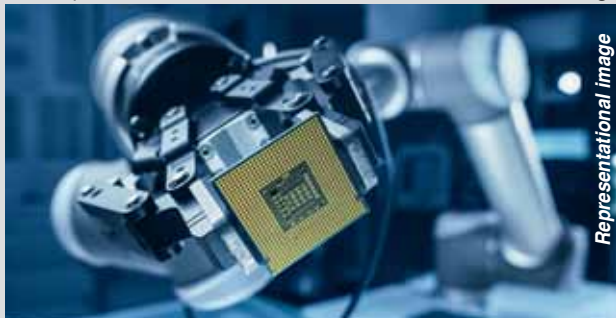
A US court struck down Trump's 'Liberation Day' tariffs, ruling them unconstitutional and beyond presidential power. The 10% import duties, which were blocked for China and the EU, were challenged by businesses fearing harm. Markets rallied in response to the decision, offering relief to the electronics sector, which relies on stable global supply chains. The Trump administration plans to appeal.

EIB leads €70 billion push into future technologies

The European Investment Bank (EIB) launched 'Tech EU,' a €70 billion initiative by 2027 to boost Europe's AI, semiconductors, health tech, and raw materials sectors. Aiming to attract €250 billion in long-term investments, it targets tech infrastructure and market reforms to compete globally, particularly against the US and China, thereby strengthening Europe's innovation and supply chain resilience.

GlobalFoundries pledges \$16 billion to expand US chip production

GlobalFoundries is investing \$16 billion to expand chip production in New York and Vermont, boosting technologies such as silicon photonics and GaN. With \$2B in federal aid and backing



Representational image

from firms like GM and Apple, the move aims to strengthen US chip supply amid AI demand and tariff threats, even as some government funding faces setbacks.

GlobalWafers boosts US investment with \$4 billion

GlobalWafers will invest an additional \$4 billion in US operations, expanding its Sherman, Texas, campus—now its US HQ and largest wafer site. Backed by \$406 million from the CHIPS Act, the move supports 300mm wafer production, which is vital for the electronics and AI industries. The expansion strengthens the US chip supply chain and is expected to add hundreds of tech jobs by 2028.

Qualcomm to acquire Alphawave in \$2.4 billion AI data centre push

Qualcomm will acquire UK chip designer Alphawave for \$2.4 billion to boost its AI data centre presence, offering a 96% premium at 183p per share. The move diversifies Qualcomm beyond mobile, aligning with its goals in AI and CPU. Alphawave's expertise strengthens Qualcomm's portfolio, with the deal expected to close by early 2026, pending regulatory approval.

Intel eyes DRAM revival with SoftBank collaboration, says reports

Intel may re-enter the memory chip market through a new ven-

ture with SoftBank, 'Saimemory,' to develop energy-efficient AI-focused DRAM. Aimed at rivaling high-bandwidth memory, but with up to 50% less power use, the tech could launch by 2030. The move signals Intel's renewed ambition in AI infrastructure after a period of absence from the memory sector.

Foxconn acquires Sharp's LCD plant for EV expansion in Japan

Sharp will sell part of its underused Kameyama LCD plant to parent Foxconn, aligning with Foxconn's push into Japan's EV market. Originally for TVs, the site now makes small LCD panels. Foxconn, aiming to start local EV production by 2027-28, has also partnered with Mitsubishi to co-develop EVs, with the first launch scheduled for Australia and New Zealand in 2026.

Renesas withdraws from the SiC market to refocus its core strategy

Renesas has scrapped plans to enter the silicon carbide (SiC) market, despite a \$2 billion supply deal with Wolfspeed, citing market shifts and strategic focus. Intense competition, high costs, and uncertain returns influenced the decision. Renesas will now prioritise microcontrollers and analogue/power chips. Wolfspeed must adjust, while rivals may gain ground in the growing SiC sector.

BYD surpasses Tesla in April's European EV sales

Chinese automaker BYD overtook Tesla in Europe's battery-electric vehicle sales for the first time, registering 7231 BEVs in April—a 169% surge. Tesla's fell 49%. BYD's total electrified sales, including hybrids, soared 359%. With new models like the Dolphin Surf and competitive pricing, BYD is reshaping Europe's EV market amid Tesla's decline and rising industry demand.

Denmark flags hidden components in renewable energy tech

Denmark issued an alert after discovering undocumented parts in East Asian-made circuit boards for green energy projects, echoing US concerns over hidden 'kill switches' in Chinese solar gear. Although sabotage has not been confirmed, concerns over digital security and supply chain integrity are growing. Europe is now reassessing its reliance on foreign tech in critical infrastructure.

TSMC prioritises Europe for expansion, over Asia

TSMC is expanding in Europe with a new Munich design centre in Germany, supporting a €10 billion joint venture in Dresden to boost advanced chip production. Meanwhile, it declined expansion offers from India, Singapore, and Qatar, citing concerns over supply chain and geopolitics. TSMC focuses on growth in Taiwan, the US, Japan, and Germany, thereby challenging US-China dominance in the semiconductor industry.

EnSilica opens advanced engineering base in Cambridge

Chip designer EnSilica has opened a new engineering hub in Cambridge, UK, staffed by six engineers to boost mmWave and RF integrated circuit design. Funded partly by a UK Space Agency grant, the hub targets growing demand in satellite communications and aerospace, expanding EnSilica's UK presence amid talent shortages in the semiconductor sector.